

Question 19 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the likely consequences of implementing HRD practices without considering the existing organisational culture and climate.

Introduction

Evaluate likely consequences — mostly negative — and say under what rare conditions some practice might still help. This is a judgement question.

Detailed points

1. **Rejection and fake data.** Forced openness in a fear climate produces fake 360-degree ratings and silent classrooms. The practice exists on paper and lies in reality.
2. **Ritualism.** Appraisal forms and training attendance are completed because they are compulsory. No behavioural change. HRD becomes a ritual, wasting time.
3. **Cynicism and worse trust.** Employees conclude management is hypocritical. Trust, which is the heart of climate, falls further. Consequence is worse than doing nothing.
4. **Wasted resources.** High spend, no transfer. Opportunity cost: the same money could have trained bosses in coaching aligned with culture.
5. **Value conflict and stress.** New HRD values (autonomy, confrontation) clash with old culture (obedience, avoidance). Employees face role stress: punished if they speak, blamed if they do not develop.
6. **Politics and inequity.** Without climate fairness, new ‘development opportunities’ are captured by in-groups. HRD increases inequality.
7. **Possible short-term optics.** A glossy programme may impress visitors or accreditation teams. Evaluation at behaviour and results levels will still fail. Optics are not effectiveness.
8. **Judgement.** Consequences are predominantly negative. HRD must be sequenced: diagnose culture/climate, adapt tools, build safety, then deepen practices. Blind implementation is professionally wrong.

Conclusion. *Verdict: implementing HRD without culture and climate analysis is likely ineffective and often harmful to trust. Diagnosis must precede design.*